

Ten Fixes To Try

There are a few ‘fixes’ you must take care of before upgrading your PC. In the following few pages, you will find tips you can try before actually upgrading—to do a cheaper upgrade instead of going in for a more expensive one, for instance. If you feel you need a new power supply, try repairing the old one first. If you think you need more RAM, consider the idea that one of your RAM chips may be bad—and you can get this replaced from your dealer. And so on.

Here, then, are 10 possible money-saving tips.

1. Does your PC shut down by itself, sometimes at intervals of half a minute, and sometimes half an hour? Does it hang for no reason whatsoever? Did you run a virus scan, and nothing showed up?

Instead of upgrading other components, think about the power supply. If it is not powerful enough, it could cause several other problems. So, get the power supply checked. In some cases, a capacitor or some other component may have blown, in which case you can get it repaired. Otherwise, too, you may consider buying a better, more powerful power supply.

2. Overheating is a frequent problem, which mostly occurs if you are using your PC during hot weather without any air conditioning. Your computer can run slow, and crash often. If this is the case, think whether your computer is indeed overheating. Do not rush to upgrade.

Overheating can be fixed in many ways, some of which have been discussed in past *Digit* issues. The most common solution is to add an extra fan, while ensuring that there is sufficient space for ventilation inside the cabinet. Remove wire clutter. If need be, buy a larger cabinet.